

Postal force helps find people to deport

Agency investigators join DHS team in move to use mail data in crackdown

BY JACOB BOGAGE AND HANNAH NATANSON

The law enforcement arm of the U.S. Postal Service has quietly begun cooperating with federal immigration officials to locate people suspected of being in the country illegally, according to two people familiar with the matter and documents obtained by The Washington Post — dramatically broadening the scope of the Trump administration's government-wide mass deportation campaign.

The U.S. Postal Inspection Service, a little-known police and investigative force for the mail agency, recently joined a Department of Homeland Security task force geared toward finding, detaining and deporting undocumented immigrants, said the people, who spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of professional reprisals.

Immigration officials are seeking photographs of the outside of envelopes and packages — an Inspection Service program known as “mail covers” — and access to the postal investigation agency's broad surveillance systems, including Postal Service online account data, package- and mail-tracking information, credit card data and financial material and IP addresses, the people said.

The postal collaboration is a significant escalation in the Trump administration's immigration crackdown. Homeland Security officials have previously partnered with tax, housing and public health authorities. But the involvement of the Postal Inspection Service, the nation's oldest law enforcement agency, means efforts to pursue undocumented immigrants have expanded into one of the most mundane government activities: delivering the mail.

The Postal Inspection Service is primarily tasked with maintaining the safety of the mail system, investigating threats and attacks on postal workers and mail facilities and keeping illegal items

SEE USPS ON A18

Border: First migrants charged with entering restricted military zone. **A9**



MAIKA ELAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Members of the Vietnam People's Army Artillery Corps perform a drill for the 50th anniversary celebration of the Vietnam War's end.

‘We were a trusted voice here’

USAID has funded decades of work to redress the Vietnam War's legacy. It's faltering under Trump.

BY REBECCA TAN

QUANG TRI PROVINCE, VIETNAM — The Vietnamese deminers who find and destroy the deadly remnants of America's war here were on break for Lunar New Year when they received word an executive order by President Donald Trump had suspended funding for their work.

For a month, they hung up the khaki uniforms stitched with American flag patches, left their metal detectors in storage, and rerouted reports of grenades, cluster munitions and mortars to the Vietnamese authorities.

“People were calling us every day,” remembered Tran Binh Phuong, who leads several hundred personnel in the largest demining operation in central Vietnam's Quang Tri province — an effort that relies wholly on U.S. funding. “They asked why, when this land still has so many

SEE VIETNAM ON A14

Vietnamese Americans: A war, their identity are top of mind. **A12**



VALERIE PLESCH/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Truc Nguyen slices lotus stems while chatting with a customer at Saigon Restaurant at Eden Center in Falls Church. The restaurant is part of a huge Vietnamese ecosystem in Northern Virginia. **Story, B1**

President pulls back on tariffs for cars and parts

Partial reprieve is latest White House retreat amid trade war volatility

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY

President Donald Trump signed an executive order Tuesday afternoon softening tariffs on imported cars and car parts, in a reprieve for auto manufacturers that had protested the levies.

While 25 percent taxes will remain on imported vehicles, the White House is changing the tariffs to ensure that they are not “stacked” on top of other levies, such as for the steel and aluminum commonly used in automobiles, according to senior Commerce Department officials. Auto companies that finish

building cars in the United States will also get some relief from tariffs on imported auto parts for two years.

“It's a little bit of help,” Trump said at the White House on Tuesday before boarding a flight to Michigan, where he held a rally to mark the first 100 days of his second term. “It's a little transition.”

The executive order marked the White House's latest retreat in recent weeks on steep levies imposed on imports from foreign trading partners. The White House has faced criticism and swooning financial markets, leading it to announce a three-month delay of some of the steepest tariffs, and temporary exemptions from import duties for some electronic products

SEE TARIFFS ON A18

China: Nation says it will not “kneel” to Trump's pressure. **A15**

She tried to expose Russia's brutal detention system — and ended up dead

Ukrainian journalist braved the occupied territories to document the reported abuse and torture of civilians

BY CATE BROWN, JARRETT LEY, CATHERINE BELTON AND ANASTACIA GALOUCHKA

The body bag was delivered to Kyiv on a flatbed truck. There was an alphanumeric code stamped across the white shroud, followed by four Cyrillic letters — a Russian abbreviation denoting “extensive damage to the coronary arteries.”

For most of the 757 Ukrainian bodies exchanged for Russian dead on Feb. 14, the Russian authorities had provided their counterparts in Kyiv with names of the deceased, nearly all male soldiers, and the dates they were killed. The final entry on the list handed to prosecutors said only “unidentified male.”

When forensic experts opened



HROMADSKO

Viktoriia Roshchyna, recalled as fearless and resolute, died in captivity at age 27. A journalism consortium, including The Post, has continued her work.

the bag, they found a female body. Her head was shaved, her neck bruised. There was a tag with her last name attached to one shin, and burn marks on her feet, according to officials familiar with an ongoing investigation by the Ukrainian Prosecutor General's Office. Medical examiners later found a broken rib and possible traces of electric shock. Some of her organs, including her brain, had been removed, officials said.

A DNA test confirmed that the body belonged to Viktoriia Roshchyna, a 27-year-old Ukrainian journalist who had disappeared into the Russian prison system after being detained while reporting in the occupied territories in August 2023. Roshchyna, the first Ukrainian journalist to

SEE PRISONS ON A10

Trump exults in a jolted nation

MICH. RALLY MARKS WHIRLWIND 100 DAYS

President heralds tariffs, deportations, federal cuts

BY MATT VISER

WARREN, MICH. — President Donald Trump arrived here Tuesday afternoon for a rally to mark his first 100 days in office, returning to a battleground state he won last year and to the cheering crowds that marked his campaign but that he has largely eschewed so far in office.

In what aides billed as a “100th Day in Office Achievement Speech,” Trump touted the rapid pace he has kept during three months of dramatic changes to the federal workforce and global economic policy that have served to reorient the country and confuse the world. He chose as his backdrop a place that has lost much of the manufacturing base that once defined the greater Detroit area — but also one that is feeling the effects of his tariff proposals and his threats to occupy nearby Canada.

“In 100 days, we have delivered the most profound change in Washington in 100 years,” Trump said.

In the first three months of his second term, Trump has imposed tariffs on foreign imports, reshaping the global economy and sending markets into a frenzy. He has

SEE TRUMP ON A7

Invoking FDR: Trump cites his early-term actions as a model. **A5**

Charting a presidency: Trump's first 100 days, by the numbers. **A6**

In D.C., anxiety, anger and exhaustion

Many District residents are left reeling by the administration's moves

BY JOE HEIM

There are still lively Sunday brunches in Dupont Circle and peaceful family picnics in Anacostia Park. Metro trains are packed, tourists flood the National Mall. Softball and soccer leagues are starting back up and U Street bars bustle. The pollen count is absurdly high.

Springtime in Washington feels, in many ways, normal.

But underneath the seeming calm there is a deep unease. As it moves beyond the 100th day of President Donald Trump's second administration, the District is on edge.

It is anxious and angry.

It is watching its step and watching its mouth.

It is exhausted.

“Me and my friends can only take so much news,” said Maria Majors, 74, as she walked in the Adams Morgan neighborhood where she grew up and still lives.

SEE MOOD ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Carney and Canada The prime minister, fresh off the Liberal Party's stunning win, now has to prove he can navigate regional differences and a rocky economy. **A15**

Uncertainty over deal The D.C. Council is split on a stadium proposal that would bring the Commanders back to Washington. **B1**

THE NATION **Experimental drugs** were found to help some cancer patients avoid surgery. **A2** **Charles E. Schumer** remains sure that voting to prevent a shutdown was the right call. **A3**

THE WORLD **India has widened** its crackdown in Kashmir after a deadly militant attack on tourists. **A8** **Power returned**, but the cause of a massive blackout in Spain remained unclear. **A15**

THE ECONOMY **Congress passed** legislation addressing the posting of sexual images of people without their consent. **A16** **Workers who screen** coal miners for black lung disease were temporarily reinstated by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. **A18**

THE REGION **Interim U.S. attorney** Ed Martin told senators he didn't know a man he had praised was a Nazi sympathizer, despite interviewing the man. **B1** **Virginia Gov. Glenn Youngkin** defended his request for John Reid to abandon his bid for lieutenant governor. **B1**

STYLE **Clever, but fake**, movie trailers are giving way to “AI slop” creations that are mainly clickbait. **C1** **FOOD** **Wine is often** said to be masculine or feminine. Some industry professionals think it's time to drop the gendered descriptors. **E1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A16
COMICS.....C5
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A19
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A8

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54202

0 70628 21100 3